ASP.NET Core uses the authentication cookie sent with the requests to rehydrate a `ClaimsPrincipal` and set the `HttpContext.User` principal for the request, as shown in figure 23.3. The important thing to note is when this process happens—in the `AuthenticationMiddleware`.

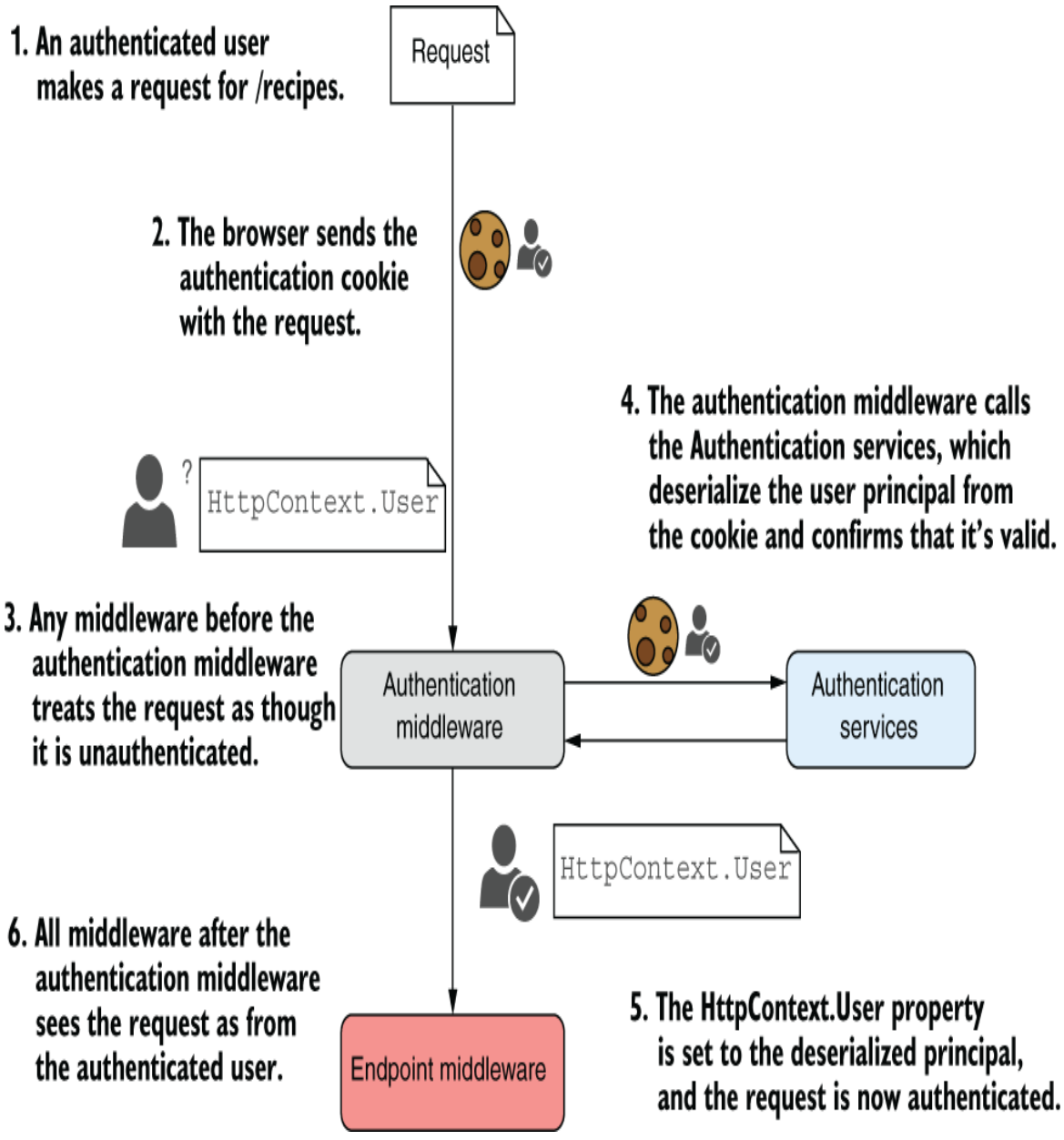


Figure 23.3 A subsequent request after signing in to an application. The cookie sent with the request contains the user principal, which is validated